

Three books I'll have my Son read before he's 18

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 29, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/0Qp8Cgj3PDA> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter shares three books he read at 17 that shaped his mindset on emotions, money, and persuasion — and that he plans to have his son read before turning 18.

Contents

-  Book 1: Awaken the Giant Within — Tony Robbins
-  Book 2: Rich Dad Poor Dad — Robert Kiyosaki
-  Book 3: Influence — Robert Cialdini

Book 1: Awaken the Giant Within — Tony Robbins 0:00

- Carter read this book at age 17, the summer before going to college
 - Describes it as having "truly changed my outlook on life"
- **Biggest takeaway:** You don't have to let external circumstances, events, or other people dictate your emotions
 - You can learn to control your own emotional state
- Frames emotional self-regulation as the single most powerful skill any person can possess

Book 2: Rich Dad Poor Dad — Robert Kiyosaki 0:21

- Also read at age 17; gave him a completely different perspective on money
 - Covers how to earn money and how to keep it
- **Biggest takeaway:** "Poor people buy liabilities while rich people buy assets"
 - This single mindset shift reframes every financial decision

Book 3: Influence — Robert Cialdini 0:21

- Carter re-reads this book **once a month** and calls it an essential reference
- Core argument: everyone is a salesperson or marketer, without exception
 - Having an Instagram or TikTok page = marketing yourself
 - Running a business = marketing your product or service
 - Applying for a job = marketing yourself to an employer

- "Marketing is essentially influence" — understanding persuasion is a universal life skill
- Calls it the best book ever written on the subject of influence and persuasion